

Key Findings: Sandwich Collection Trends and Peak Weeks

An evidence-based review of recorded sandwich collections, April 2020-September 2026

Prepared September 28, 2026. Weekly rankings include completed weeks through September 22, 2026.

Key takeaways

The highest completed Wednesday-Tuesday collection week on record was January 15-21, 2025, with 28,927 sandwiches logged. The next highest was November 15-21, 2023, with 27,810. These are totals of individual and group sandwiches in current collection records.

Collections increased across the last four full calendar years: 440,371 in 2022, 473,409 in 2023, 501,856 in 2024, and 526,083 in 2025. The 2025 total was 24,227 (+4.8%) above 2024. These counts measure collections recorded, not demand or people served.

Group collections play a substantial role in high-volume weeks. A group log is a category of entry, not a host location; it should be reported separately from geographic hosts.

1. Growth in recorded collections

The first recorded month, April 2020, had 847 sandwiches. The program's calendar-year totals grew substantially afterward. The 2020 total covers only April 22 through December, so it is not a like-for-like full-year comparison.

Calendar year	Sandwiches logged
2020*	44,958
2021	281,395
2022	440,371
2023	473,409
2024	501,856
2025	526,083

Monthly totals fluctuate rather than increasing every month. November 2022 is the largest complete calendar month through 2025 in these records (60,082). January 2025 and November 2023 were also high-volume months.

High-volume month	Sandwiches logged
November 2022	60,082
January 2025	59,022
October 2024	55,253
November 2023	54,849

Monthly totals use collection dates within calendar months; weekly totals below use Wednesday-Tuesday windows. They are not interchangeable.

2. Locations and group contributions

The highest named host-location totals in the full 2025 calendar year were Dunwoody/PTC, Alpharetta, and East Cobb/Roswell. Intown and Sandy Springs have more than one host-name spelling in the records; those variants are combined below.

Named host location, 2025	Sandwiches logged
Dunwoody/PTC	90,011
Alpharetta	74,798
East Cobb/Roswell	69,520
Intown (combined name variants)	55,441
Sandy Springs/Chastain (combined name variants)	24,701
Flowery Branch	12,706

Entries filed under the separate 'Groups' host-name category totaled 186,327 in 2025, about 35% of the year's 526,083 sandwiches. This is not one physical distribution site and should not be ranked as a geographic host. The location totals above include any group counts recorded within those hosts' own entries.

3. Seasonal variation

Across the four full calendar years 2022-2025, November averaged 49,900 recorded sandwiches per month, followed by January at 48,273. August averaged 32,849, the lowest of the twelve months. These are four-year monthly averages, not an estimate of demand.

Month	Average	Month	Average
Jan	48,273	Jul	36,283
Feb	43,493	Aug	32,849
Mar	39,256	Sep	38,368
Apr	39,830	Oct	43,714
May	35,727	Nov	49,900
Jun	40,949	Dec	36,791

The pattern is not uniform: November 2024 had 31,991, far below November 2022's 60,082. A few large group entries can substantially shift monthly totals; the figures do not establish a predictable holiday or weather effect.

4. Peak sandwich collection weeks

Each row below covers Wednesday through Tuesday. 'Individual' and 'Group' refer to how sandwiches were counted within the records; their sum is the weekly total.

Completed week	Total	Individual	Group
Jan 15-21, 2025	28,927	7,361	21,566
Nov 15-21, 2023	27,810	8,136	19,674
Jan 11-17, 2023	27,132	5,134	21,998
Jan 14-20, 2026	24,717	4,570	20,147
Sep 25-Oct 1, 2024	24,664	6,617	18,047

The largest week, January 15-21, 2025, included a 19,706-sandwich group entry dated January 20. The November 15-21, 2023 week included a 19,414-sandwich 'Groups' entry; the full week was 27,810, not 19,414. The September 25-October 1, 2024 week totaled 24,664.

5. What the regular weeks show

The median logged Wednesday-Tuesday week rose from 8,168 in 2022 to 9,471 in 2025. Medians are less influenced than averages by unusually large group entries. The table describes weeks with a recorded total; it should not be read as a guarantee that every week had complete reporting.

Year	Weeks with logs	Median weekly total
2022	50	8,168
2023	50	8,817
2024	50	9,121
2025	51	9,471

High-volume weeks demonstrate that more sandwiches were recorded during those periods. The collection entries alone do not tell us whether a peak was caused by a special event, a holiday campaign, an emergency response, or changes in how entries were reported.

6. Interpreting these findings

The data supports a sustained, multi-location collection operation with both recurring hosts and sizable group participation. It does not measure volunteer headcount or retention, unmet need, distribution outcomes, program costs, or the monetary value of sandwiches. Those questions require separate sources before they can be reported as facts.

Data and counting notes

Source: production sandwich_collections records, excluding soft-deleted entries. Latest completed weekly window: September 16-22, 2026; September 23-29 is still open. Calendar-year and monthly figures use collection_date. Weekly windows are Wednesday-Tuesday by collection_date, not submission date.

Record total = individual_sandwiches plus the sum of group_collections counts; if the JSON group list is empty, use legacy group1_count and group2_count instead. String-encoded JSON group lists are parsed. JSON and legacy columns are never added together. Figures represent data as logged, not independently verified deliveries; category corrections can change future reports.